

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Tsunami

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Near the coast, strong or long shaking, a sudden unusual sea rise or retreat, or a loud ocean roar can signal a tsunami. After shaking stops, move to high ground and inland immediately. Do not wait for an official warning when natural warning signs are present.

Do now.

☐**Protect during shaking**

01

Drop, Cover and Hold On first if the earthquake is still occurring.

☐**Follow evacuation signs**

02

Move uphill and inland along the designated route, on foot if roads are blocked.

☐**Stay off the shore**

03

Never go to watch waves or exposed seabed.

☐**Wait for clearance**

04

Stay out of the evacuation zone until authorities say it is safe.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use natural warning signs to move inland and uphill immediately after shaking. Walk if roads are jammed and a safe pedestrian route is available. Stay away from the shore through later waves; quiet water or lack of a broadcast is not an all-clear.

Watch for.

The first wave may not be largest. Dangerous currents can last for hours.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Know coastal evacuation routes before visiting. Use designated vertical evacuation structures where local plans provide them.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Tsunami · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/tsunami/>